WHY AREN'T INDIANS HAVING KIDS?*



Financial limitations
38%



Housing limitations
22%



Unemployment/ job insecurity
21%



Partner or family pressure
19%



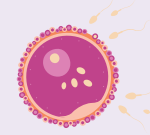
Lack of sufficient/ quality childcare
18%



Poor general health or chronic illnesses
15%



Limited access to pregnancy-related care
14%



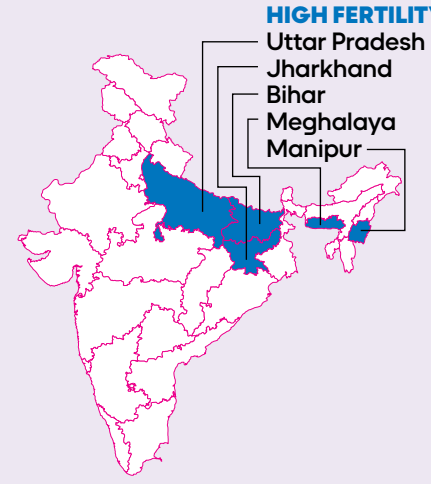
Infertility or difficulty conceiving
13%

MANY CITE GROWING ANXIETY ABOUT THE FUTURE—FROM CLIMATE CHANGE (16%) TO POLITICAL AND SOCIAL INSTABILITY (14%)—AS THE REASONS

*Based on responses to a survey by UNFPA-YouGov

'HIGH FERTILITY AND LOW FERTILITY DUALITY'

Fertility has fallen below the replacement level (2.1) in 31 states/UTs, but remains high in 5 states, says the UNFPA report

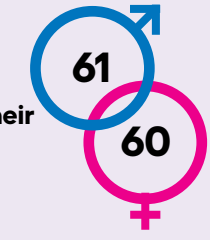


REASONS FOR DISPARITIES
Differences in economic opportunities, access to healthcare, education levels, and gender and social norms

LACK OF REPRODUCTIVE AGENCY

● Men ● Women (%)

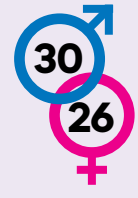
Faced some limitation or the other in their reproductive rights and agency



Couldn't use a contraceptive of their choice, one of the highest figures in the world



Forced to keep a baby they did not want, the highest in the countries surveyed



Forced to use contraceptives when they wanted to have a baby, the highest in the countries surveyed



Could not access medical advice or services regarding contraception



THE SOLUTIONS

- More contraceptive choices for men beyond vasectomy and condoms
- Universal access to sexual and reproductive healthcare services
- High-quality, accessible and affordable childcare through government-subsidised facilities
- More equitable family leave policies—paternity leave in amounts similar to maternity leave
- Efforts to end gender-based violence
- Gender-friendly regional, subnational and employer-level policies
- Focus on fertility should not be rooted in ethnonationalism, where the state's goal is not simply to facilitate certain birth rates but to apply these to certain groups